2026 [Updated]

Academic Mobility Guidebook

A comprehensive guide about exchange opportunities at Nazarbayev University

NAZARBAYEV UNIVERSITY

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION

Preface

Dear student,

This book contains all the information you need to know to get acquainted with exchange opportunities at NU. Please refer to the table of contents below for guidance.

At the moment of publishing this material (October 31, 2025), all the processes in regard to mobility programs were factual and based on the then-current partner universities.

As of the latest update (February 7, 2026), the application process, eligibility to participate, information on the current SSH School Manager, as well as several minor procedural details have been updated.

Please note that over time, new changes and partnerships can be implemented, while those mentioned here may no longer be accurate.

Best wishes,
Ministry of Education

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Benefits of Academic Mobility

- Experience living abroad and adapting to a new environment
- Develop responsibility, maturity, and independence
- Improve English proficiency through daily practice
- Strengthen communication and interpersonal skills
- Gain a deeper understanding of different traditions, cultures, and lifestyles
- Build lasting friendships and global connections
- Access high-quality education at the host university

Eligibility to Participate

- Full-time NU students who are at least 18 years old*
- Applicants must be on good academic standing (CGPA 3.00 or above out of 4.00; no misconduct cases)
- Applicants must show an aptitude, motivation, and maturity to thrive in the environment of the host country
- No incomplete grades in any courses and no disciplinary violations
- **Insight:** Based on the experience of exchange students it is essential to have a high academic standing and engagement in extracurricular activities (particularly leadership positions)

**Undergraduate students must complete at least 2 semesters, while graduate students must complete at least 1 semester. Keep in mind that for Undergraduates, 1st and 4th year students are not eligible for exchange.*

Forms of Academic Mobility

Academic Exchange
One or two semesters credit bearing program on a reciprocal basis with subsequent transfer of credits. Inter-institutional agreement (IIA) is a must.
Note: Exchange students are nominated by Home Institutions (NU Schools).

Study Abroad / Module Programs
Study modules that are credit bearing program at Host Institution on a non-reciprocal basis, with the possibility of transfer of credits.

Research Internships
These programs allow students to undertake research experiences preliminary approved by School (credit bearing / non-credit bearing).

Cultural Mobility
Short-term cultural exploration visit abroad (1 week to 1 month, non-credit bearing).

Application Process

Call for nominations from NU partner institutions to the Mobility Team (Department of Internalization, DI)

Announcement to Academic Managers of NU Schools

Emails sent to eligible students inviting them to apply

Selection Committee Review (NU Schools)

Nominations submitted to the Mobility Team (DI) by NU Schools

Host Institution's review of nominated candidates

Admission and invitation letters issued by Host Institution directly to students

Student's personal preparation of visa and required documents

Signing the Statement for *Exemption from Responsibility and Limits of Acceptable Risk* with the School's Academic Manager

Departure to the Host Institution

Informing the Mobility Team of arrival at the Host Institution

Application Submission

Applicant must submit to the **School Selection Committee** the following documents:

- Application form
- Resume or CV
- Statement of purpose*
- Official transcript of academic record
- Official enrollment verification form
- Recommendation letter from a faculty member or advisor

While the aforementioned documents are the standard application package, each School or Academic Program may require **additional documents.** It is the responsibility of students to consider specific requirements.

**There are no specific requirements for the statement of purpose. It should be written by the applicant and indicate the reasons why the School Selection Committee should choose you among the other applicants. Please specify your expectations from participating in this program, your motivation and future plans*

Important Points Before and After Completion

When nominated for the exchange, ensure that the courses you plan to take at the Host Institution are discussed with your **School's Academic Manager**, approved by the **Department Chair or Program Director**, and have NU equivalents in order to be officially transferred later.

After completing an Academic Exchange or Study Abroad program, the Host Institution must send a **physical copy of the official transcript** to the Department of Internationalization (DI), which will forward it to the School for credit transfer.

Course grades from these programs are **not included** in the NU CGPA, except in cases of "Fail" or its equivalent. In other words, the system of credit transfer works by the Pass/Fail. The Registrar's Office does not inform the School of student grades, as the School is already aware.

Upon their return, NU outgoing exchange students must start attending classes at NU within **the first week of the new semester**.

Students are **responsible** for coordinating with their professors to catch up on any missed coursework. NU does not guarantee that absences due to mobility will be excused.

DI or CAC?

Students often tend to confuse these two structures because, at first glance, they seem the same as they are closely working with students and providing them with various opportunities. Here is an overview:

The Department of Internationalization (DI) promotes and coordinates student mobility programs, and is mainly responsible for the following:

- Calling for applications
- Sending documents of selected students to the Host Institutions
- Approval of exchange programs proposed from outside by students

Career Advising Center (CAC) assists NU students with internships, job search, interview skills, resume review, alumni issues, and graduate application, hence:

- Educating in experiential learning programs
- Connecting students and alumni with internships provided by the employers
- Facilitate Internship programs in cooperation with NU schools

List of Partner Universities

Nazarbayev University has Student Exchange Agreements with the following institutions:

- ADA University, Azerbaijan
- Aegean University, Greece
- Alicante University, Spain
- Almeria University, Spain
- Autonomous University of Madrid, Spain
- Basilicata University, Italy
- Bern University, Switzerland
- Bremen University, Germany
- Chinese University of Hong Kong – Shenzhen, China
- Daegu Gyeongbuk Institute of Science and Technology, South Korea
- Eberhard Karls University of Tübingen, Germany
- Fachhochschule Dortmund – University of Applied Sciences and Arts, Germany
- Freie University of Berlin, Germany
- Friedrich Schiller University Jena, Germany (SSH students only)
- Georgia University, the United States of America
- Grenoble INP, France (SEDS students only)
- Groningen University, Netherlands
- Hertie School, Germany (GSPP students only)

List of Partner Universities

- Hong Kong University, China
- Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, China (GSB students only)
- Hong Kong University of Science and Technology – Guangzhou, China
- Humboldt University of Berlin, Germany
- Kazimierz Wielki University, Poland
- KDI School of Public Policy and Management, South Korea (GSPP students only)
- Kyrgyz-Turkish “Manas” University, Kyrgyzstan
- Koç University, Turkey
- Lee Kuan Yew School of Public Policy, National University of Singapore, Singapore (GSPP students only)
- Lodz University of Technology, Poland
- Lorraine University, France
- Nagasaki University, Japan
- National University of Uzbekistan, Uzbekistan
- New Uzbekistan University, Uzbekistan
- Northwestern Polytechnical University, China
- OSCE Academy in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan
- PDP University, Uzbekistan
- Renmin University of China, China

List of Partner Universities

- Salymbekov University, Kyrgyzstan
- Samarkand State University, Uzbekistan
- Sabancı University, Turkey
- Stavanger University, Norway
- Southwestern University of Finance and Economics, China
- Sungkyunkwan University, South Korea
- Tartu University, Estonia
- Technical University of Dresden, Germany (SSH only)
- Toronto University, Canada
- Trinity College Dublin, Ireland
- Tsinghua University, China
- Tsinghua University, School of Public Policy and Management, China (GSPP students only)
- Tsinghua University, School of Management and Economics, China
- Tsukuba University, Japan
- Ulsan National Institute of Science and Technology, South Korea
- Universiti Teknologi PETRONAS, Malaysia
- Universiti Malaya, Malaysia
- Vilnius University, Lithuania

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What are the possible expenses to expect?
A: Although programs may provide financial aid and cover the expenses, normally students are expected to pay for:

- 2-way flight tickets
- Accommodation
- Visa
- Medical Insurance
- Food
- Miscellaneous

Q: Does NU have Erasmus+ agreements?
A: Yes, NU has numerous agreements for Student Mobility programs within the framework of the Erasmus program.

Q: Can students find and participate in mobility programs on their own?
A: Yes, NU students can participate in Student Mobility programs on their own. However, the respective NU School still has to approve the program as credit-bearing.

Q: Who announces mobility opportunities?
A: Each School announces exchange opportunities via email with all the requirements and set deadlines.

Q: How long do student mobility programs usually last?
A: The most common period of academic exchange for most students is one semester. However, the duration of student mobility programs can vary, ranging from a few weeks to a full academic year.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Are mobility programs free for NU students?
A: Mobility opportunities provided by NU based on NU cooperation links usually include Tuition fee waiver. Other expenses (2-way air fare, accommodation, food expenses/costs, visa fee, medical insurance, miscellaneous expenses and additional university fees) are covered by the student.

Q: What are possible challenges along the student mobility program?
A: Challenges can include cultural adjustment, language barriers, homesickness, differences in educational systems, administrative complexities related to visa and travel regulations, and financial differences for living expenses.

Q: Can I participate in academic mobility if I have a family or dependents?
A: There are no restrictions for students with families or dependents. However, visa issues and all the costs for their expenses should be borne by students.

Q: Do I need to know the local language to participate in an academic mobility program?
A: Many courses at Host Institutions are usually offered in English, while some of them might require proficiency in the local language. Always check the language requirements of the specific program/course you're interested in.

School Managers' Contacts

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Contacts of students

We also created a list of students who have completed their exchange semesters! Feel free to reach them if you have questions regarding their experience, countries to which they have been to, etc.

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Contacts of students

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Karim Galiyev, WLLC student. Exchange student to Malaysia in Spring'25, University of Malaya.
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Study Abroad Opportunities Link



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